have thought of us as they waited for the dusk, or last light in the army parlance, to start the fireworks. They must have thought we were the stupidest of donkeys.'

As darkness descended on the Tawang Chu, the first salvos were fired and soon mortar bombs began exploding all around the convoy ground and the officers' mess. 'The Brigade Commander [Kalyan Singh], who had fought against Rommel in the Second World War, jumped off the verandah and took cover in a nearby ditch. Within seconds at least twenty others also jumped in, mostly on top of him. A strong well-built man, he silently rose, shaking off the terrified lot and walked over to his Willis jeep. My CO who otherwise was quite a fidgety person, had kept his cool. He had with him his black Labrador, Quonde, on the leash. He too got into his jeep with his dog, orderly, and Ajit Singh his driver, and drove off behind the Commander's jeep.' A few minutes later, there was a deafening roar as the Engineers blew up Bridge 4. By now, the entire lot of men at the convoy ground had taken to their heels, scrambling up the track in the darkness, in full headlong retreat. Khullar, on foot after abandoning his 1-ton vehicle, 'looked back and found that the Chinese had lit up their camp fires. They must have been very pleased with themselves.'

So began and ended the battle for Bridge 4 at Jang on the evening of 24 October. Needless to say, Jang was abandoned within the hour. So pathetic and feeble was the Indian response, that the authors of the *Official History of 1962* felt the need to pad the account with a description of an artillery duel before the bridge was blown up.

SE-LA

The main ridge from the Bhutan border runs west to east linking up with the main Himalayan range at the orographic knot of the Gorichen Glacier and Kangto (23,260 feet), which is the highest peak on the watershed separating NEFA from Tibet. The Se-la Ridge also forms the watershed between the Nyamjang Chu and the Kameng river basins, while also forming the geographical and cultural boundary between the Tawang region and the Dirang Dzong sector. Apart from Se-la, the other prominent passes that run across the feature are Tse-la, Kya-la, Chebra-la and Orka-la, all of them well over 13,000 feet in altitude. From the southern side, the Se-la massif is a sheer escarpment and the pass can only be approached along a lateral road running up from Senge Dzong. Se-la Top is situated at a height of 13,746